

Somalia Conflict Analysis

MAIN ACTORS

Al-Shabaab	Documented exploitation of governance deficits and humanitarian vulnerabilities sustaining coordinated operations, controlling roughly 30 percent of Somalia's territory.
Communal militias	Persistent inter-clan conflict over scarce resources driving violence across multiple regions, with dual roles emerging as both supporters of government counter-insurgency operations and, at times, actors susceptible to Al-Shabaab influence or opposition to government forces.
Political elites and security forces	Limited state capacity and political polarization confining government control largely to Mogadishu, with constitutional issues and cyclical electoral crises deepening institutional fragility.

REGIONS WITH STRONG PEACEBUILDING CAPACITY

SEPI RANKINGS — STRONG PEACEBUILDING CAPACITY

#	Region	SEPI	Education	Health Access	Food Security	Poverty Reduction	Climate	Events /100k
1	Bari	0.751	0.609	0.665	0.833	0.886	0.796	58
2	Awdal	0.720	0.744	0.417	0.875	0.998	0.731	2
3	Nugaal	0.711	0.683	0.503	0.875	0.927	0.652	3
4	Sanaag	0.686	0.363	0.691	0.917	0.934	0.707	7
5	Woqooyi Galbeed	0.634	0.836	0.321	0.875	0.828	0.528	1

All five top regions fall under Somaliland or Puntland governance, entities that have maintained institutional continuity since the early post-conflict period. This relatively long-term stability may signal an enabling environment for gradual recovery in economic and service delivery systems.

Economic scores stand out: Awdal driven by livestock export economies; Bari driven by Bosaso port trade and commercial activity; Nugaal as Puntland's administrative capital (Garowe). The data suggests that in these top-performing regions, strong economic performance may act as a counterbalance to other weaknesses.

Nugaal: ranking may overstate current resilience; 2024–2025 drought left wells dried up, likely not captured in SEPI data.

Woqooyi Galbeed leads education nationally, reflecting Hargeisa's role as Somaliland's de facto capital with concentrated education services.

SEPI RANKINGS — WEAK PEACEBUILDING CAPACITY

#	Region	SEPI	Education	Health Access	Food Security	Poverty Reduction	Climate	Events /100k
18	Middle Shabelle	0.068	0.046	0.157	0.625	0.000	0.328	47
17	Bay	0.123	0.303	0.314	0.000	0.689	0.434	25
16	Lower Juba	0.299	0.261	0.048	0.875	0.564	0.382	37
15	Middle Juba	0.324	N/A	0.116	0.667	N/A	0.443	14
14	Mudug	0.360	0.377	0.208	0.542	0.262	0.542	9

Middle Shabelle emerges as a significant outlier, exhibiting the lowest rates of poverty reduction and public service provision alongside a high frequency of conflict events. Al-Shabaab has retaken previously cleared towns; government military operations remain ongoing.

Middle Juba's SEPI score reflects significant data limitations rather than a complete picture; restricted access in Al-Shabaab-controlled territories limits the availability and reliability of underlying indicators. As of 2022, Middle Juba held the lowest Human Development Index score of any subnational region globally.

Bottom regions share the convergence of Al-Shabaab territorial control, protracted IDP displacement, and repeated climate shocks. These are not isolated failures — they represent compound, interacting crises.

SOURCES OF RESILIENCE

Somaliland regions remain conflict-free, their stability rooted in over three decades of autonomous governance since 1991, the strongest institutional resilience case in the Somalia data.

One of the most effective resilience mechanisms in the current period was clan militia mobilisation against al-Shabaab.

The Defectors' Rehabilitation Programme, operating in Mogadishu, Baidoa, and Kismayo, has processed approximately 3,000 people since 2012. However, it faces critical limitations.